

Deal 1 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners

Q

7

5

3

♣

6

2

♦

A

7

6

♠

Q

J

9

4

♥

A

9

6

4

♣

A

8

3

♦

K

Q

J

5

♠

K

10

♥

Decide How to Develop Winners

Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Deal 3 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners

A

K

5

♣

K

5

♦

A

7

6

♠

A

8

6

5

3

♥

9

8

4

3

♣

Q

J

10

7

3

♦

8

2

♠

K

4

♥

Decide How to Develop Winners

Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 3 2
♥ A 8 7 3
♦ 9 7 4
♣ J 10 2

♠ K Q J 5

♥ K 10

♦ A 8 3

♣ A 9 6 4



♠ 10 8 4

♥ 6 5 2

♦ K Q J 10 5

♣ K 8

♠ A 7 6

♥ Q J 9 4

♦ 6 2

♣ Q 7 5 3

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North

You were lucky the ♥A was with West.

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♦K.

Winners: ♠=4 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=1 Total = 6

You need 3 more winners, and they must come from the ♥ suit. The danger is that when you knock out the ♥A, East may take too many ♦s. To exhaust West of ♦s you hold-up your ♦A until the third round.

Next you start on ♥s by playing ♥K, then overtaking the ♥10. Assume that West wins the second ♥.

You were fortunate it was West who took the ♥A, and that he has no ♦ to return. If he plays a ♥ or a ♠ you will win in dummy. If he plays a ♣ you will jump up with the ♣A and take your winners, 9 in all.

But if you had not held-up your ♦A even good luck wouldn't have helped you.

Board 3

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 7 6
 ♥ A 8 6 5 3
 ♦ K 5
 ♣ A K 5

♠ 9 4 3
 ♥ Q 9 7 2
 ♦ A 8 4
 ♣ Q 10 2



♠ 8 2
 ♥ K 4
 ♦ Q J 10 7 3
 ♣ 9 8 4 3

♠ K Q J 10 5
 ♥ J 10
 ♦ 9 6 2
 ♣ J 7 6

West	North	East	South
1♥	Pass	1NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			

3NT by East bank; ♠A, ♦K, ♦Q. You take your ♥K, cash the two good ♦s, then lead to dummy for the ♣AK and ♥A. Voila!

You were lucky that North had the ♦A since he only had 3 ♠s.

But what if North actually held 4 ♠s? No problem, in that case the ♠s would have split 4-4 so the defenders could only win 3 ♠ tricks and the ♦A.

The hold-up lets you make the contract whenever North holds the ♦A. And if South happened to hold the ♦A??? You go down.

East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♠K.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=2 ♦=0 ♣=2 Total = 5

Even if ♥s split 3-3 you could only get 2 extra winners there, so it should be clear that you must establish the ♦s. You will have to drive out the ♦A and hope they don't win too many ♠s at that time. You can help your chances by a hold-up of the ♠A until the third round.

Having just taken the third ♠ trick you now work on ♦s by first playing the ♦K, then continuing the suit. North wins the third one with his ♦A. And now the good news - he has no ♠ left to reach his partner's good tricks. So North plays the ♥Q.

At this point in the play you have three tricks in the